

Sara Melchionda

MA Candidate
Prospective PhD Researcher

Contacts

 <https://saramelchionda.github.io/>

 sara.melchionda@edu.unito.it

Spoken Languages

Native Italian

Advanced English CEFR C1

Cambridge Assessment English

Skills

- Proficient in **Stata** and **R** for social research
- Developing proficiency in **Python** for data scraping and NLP tasks
- Use of **LLMs** and **BERT** for automated text analysis
- Expert in extracting and managing Reddit/Telegram datasets
- **Adobe** Suite (Photoshop, Premiere, After Effects)

Interests

Digital cultures, video games, and professional multimedia content editing

About Me

- MA Candidate in Public and Political Communication with a strong focus on **Computational Social Science**. My research specializes in the analysis of **online political extremism** and **conspiracy narratives**. I am currently developing an experimental thesis utilizing **Large Language Models** and **BERT** to detect sarcasm and radicalization dynamics within anonymous digital communities. Proficient in **quantitative data analysis** and digital research methodologies.

Research & Academic Experience

- **Master's Thesis Project** Present
Developing an experimental framework to analyze online conspiracy discourse on Reddit. I am testing the performance of **BERT** and **LLMs** in decoding **vernacular internet slang and sarcasm**, aiming to identify and correct **measurement biases** inherent in traditional dictionary-based methods.
- **CONSPIRE Project (EU-Funded)** Present
Research Participant
Actively participating in an **international research project** focused on the dynamics of **conspiracy theories**. The activities include theoretical seminars and role-playing simulations designed to model and study the mechanisms of **radicalization and misinformation** spread within digital environments.
- **Advanced Methodology Labs**
Data Analyst Trainee 2024 - present
Big Data Analysis: Acquired advanced skills in managing **large datasets**, focusing on the **social implications** of algorithmic sorting and digital traces.
Stata & R Lab: Developed proficiency in **quantitative data management, econometric modeling, and statistical inference** for social sciences.
Collegio Carlo Alberto Lab: Currently attending a high-level specialization lab on advanced research design and social complexity.

Education

- **Master's Degree in Public and Political Communication** 2024 - ongoing
University of Turin
Focus on Computational Social Science and data-driven political analysis. High-achieving record in core methodological courses, including **30/30 cum laude** in Quantitative Methods and in Polls, Media & Public Opinion, and **30/30** in Big Data & Methods for Content Analysis.
- **Bachelor's Degree in Intelcultural Communication** 2021 - 2024
Università of Turin
Graduated with a thesis titled: "How the linguistic approach on queer and gendered themes in TV series has changed: a focus on Grey's Anatomy". The project, written and discussed in English, analyzed linguistic shifts and media representation through a sociolinguistic lens.
- **Diploma in Audiovisual and Multimedia Production** 2017 - 2021
IIS M. Buniva
Final grade: 100/100. Developed foundational technical skills in digital media production and multimedia editing.